CAPITAL YOUTH EXPO · COMPETITION RULEBOOK

No. 04 • TECHNOLOGY

Hackathon (Innovation Sprint)

Inspired by Pakistan's largest national AI & Tech Hackathon framework, participating teams ideate, build, and pitch a functional software, AI, or hardware prototype that solves a real-world problem across designated national innovation tracks, culminating in a live Grand Finale showcase on December 2, 2026.

Competition Code: 04-HK

Rules & Specifications

Official Competition Tracks (Choose One)	• **Track 1: Education (EdTech):** Adaptive learning platforms, student productivity tools, and skill-development solutions. • **Track 2: Healthcare:** Accessible diagnostic screening tools, patient management, and health-tech platforms. • **Track 3: FinTech & Financial Inclusion:** Micro-finance tools, smart budgeting, digital payments, and SME solutions. • **Track 4: Smart Agriculture & Climate:** Predictive crop analytics, resource monitoring, and environmental sustainability tools. • **Track 5: Urdu & Regional Tech:** Local language NLP, voice assistants, and accessibility software for local communities. • **Track 6: Open Innovation:** Disruptive software, AI agents, cybersecurity, smart-campus tools, or IoT breakthroughs.
Team Composition	Minimum 1, maximum 5 members per team. All members must be currently enrolled university or college students. Cross-department and interdisciplinary teams (combining developers, AI enthusiasts, designers, and presenters) are highly encouraged.
Duration & Hybrid Format	Multi-stage competition consisting of an Online Build Phase (Nov 16 – Nov 28, 2026) followed by an On-Site Grand Finale & Live Pitch (December 2, 2026). Teams select their track upon registration and develop their working prototype during the designated build window.
Tech Stack & AI Tools	Any programming language, cloud platform, AI model/API, framework, or hardware platform may be used. Use of open-source libraries, public APIs, UI component kits, and AI coding assistants is fully permitted, provided all external APIs and libraries are disclosed in the repository README.md at submission.
Originality Rule	The core application logic, system integration, and project workflow must be produced during the official competition window (Nov 16 – Nov 28, 2026). Submitting another person's project, cloning an existing full product without original development, or submitting undisclosed pre-built projects will result in immediate disqualification.

Submission Requirements (Due Nov 28, 11:59 PM)	• A public GitHub or GitLab repository link with complete source code and a clear README.md. • A working live deployment link (if web/cloud-based) AND a maximum 2-minute recorded video walkthrough demonstrating the working prototype. • A presentation slide deck (PDF or PPTX) for the Grand Finale pitch on December 2, 2026, consisting of a maximum 5-minute live presentation followed by 2 minutes of Jury Q&A.
Judging Criteria (100 Points Total)	• **Innovation & Creativity (25%):** Novelty of the approach and creativity in addressing the chosen track's problem statement. • **Technical Execution & Functionality (25%):** Working status of the live prototype, system stability, and effective integration of code/AI/APIs. • **Real-World Impact & Viability (25%):** Practical usefulness, scalability, and potential to solve real community, campus, or industry needs. • **Presentation, UI/UX & Pitch Clarity (25%):** User interface quality, clarity of the live demonstration, and effectiveness of the 5-minute pitch.
Conduct & Penalties	• Attacking event Wi-Fi/infrastructure or rival teams' devices/deployments leads to immediate disqualification and disciplinary action. • Major feature development must freeze upon the final submission deadline; only minor environment/configuration fixes are permitted prior to live judging on Expo Day.

General Rules — Applicable to This Category

— Strict Punctuality — Finalist teams must report to their designated exhibition desk or presentation stage on December 2, 2026, at least 15 minutes before their scheduled slot. Late arrival results in automatic forfeit.

— Fair Play & Sportsmanship — Abusive behavior, arguments with coordinators or judges, or unsportsmanlike conduct leads to immediate disqualification.

— Original Work & IP Ownership — Participating teams retain 100% intellectual property rights over their code and prototypes, while granting the Capital Youth Expo organizing committee permission to showcase project demos and photos for promotional purposes. Plagiarism leads to immediate disqualification.

— Network & Infrastructure Integrity — Disrupting or attempting unauthorized access to event networks, judging platforms, or another team's systems is strictly prohibited.

— Judge's Decision — The decision of the technical screening panel and Grand Finale jury is indisputable and final.

These rules are issued by the Capital Youth Expo organizing committee and apply alongside the master rulebook. The committee reserves the right to modify rules, time limits, or format if necessary. Judges' decisions are final and non-contestable.